# Connor Close

Programmer · AI, Gameplay & Multiplayer

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## PROFILE

Gameplay Programmer with 6+ years professional experience shipping titles across multiple platforms in both indie and AAA development. Specialist in AI behaviour and navigation, multiplayer replication and gameplay systems across Unreal Engine, Unity and proprietary client engines. A programmer who has managed and mentored juniors, and who embeds quickly in external client teams to deliver high-quality features and key milestones.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

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| **Engines** | Unreal Engine, Unity, proprietary client engines |
| **Languages** | C++, C#, Unreal Blueprints |
| **AI & Navigation** | Detour/Recast Navigation, 3D Pathfinding, Custom nav links and AI Behaviour |
| **Multiplayer** | Gameplay Replication in Unreal Engine |
| **Gameplay** | Core Gameplay feature design, Rapid Prototyping, Optimisation and Unreal GAS. |
| **Leadership & Process** | Client co-dev, Code Reviews and Practises, Git + Perforce Version Control and Jira tasking |

## EXPERIENCE

### Climax Studios / Gameplay Programmer

Feb 2022 – Present

Liverpool · Hybrid | Projects: **Exodus**, plus NDA-covered titles

- Gameplay programmer on Exodus, working directly with the client's Senior Systems Engineer to deliver gameplay and AI features.
- Co-owned AI and gameplay design, architecture and implementation (50% ownership), contributing to core gameplay systems, AI behaviour and navigation.
- Full ownership of hover-based AI navigation, patrol and combat behaviour on current NDA projects, built in the client's proprietary engine.
- Embedded within external client development teams, keeping communication clear and consistent to hit key milestones.

### Psycho Hound Ltd / Lead Programmer

Jul 2020 – Feb 2022

Remote | Titles: **AUDL 2022**, **Ruff 'n' Tumble: Mayhem**

- Programming lead on AUDL 2022 and Ruff 'n' Tumble: Mayhem.
- Held full ownership of gameplay and multiplayer replication systems.
- Created, assigned and managed junior developers' workloads through Jira, providing ongoing technical guidance and mentoring.
- Ran code reviews and set repository workflows, version control and coding standards to keep quality and consistency high.

## EDUCATION

**BSc (Hons) Computer Science with Games** 2:1 · Sheffield Hallam University — 2017 – 2020

**Level 3 Diploma, Creative & Digital Media** Triple Distinction · Playground Squad, Manchester — 2016 – 2017

**Level 3 Extended Diploma in IT** Triple Distinction · Bright Future Ltd, Manchester — 2014 – 2016